Win Analysis: Florim USA 02-2026

Novara wins Florim USA with lowest price, most suitable product; post-sales contract dispute almost quashes deal

KEY DECISION FACTORS

- Novara "cheapest" at $4.4K/year, plus $15K implementation; attractive to upper management; deciding factor in winning deal
- Product Differentiator: Novara only tool that allowed exclusive access to EHS team to manually input data; no company-wide logins required
- Product Gap: Disliked Intelex, EHS Insight's requirement that all 400 employees have logins, ability to input information directly
- Sales Differentiator: Novara sales rep brought additional resources into sales conversation; Florim USA impressed by ISO focus
- "Great" demos; rep took time to show Florim USA "everything [Novara] could do"

SCOOP

Novara beat EHS Insight and Intelex with their lowest price and a product best-suited to Florim USA's needs. Julie Knotts, EHS Project Manager, needed to upgrade from paper-based record-keeping to improve efficiency and prepare for ISO safety certification. She and two colleagues considered Novara, Intelex, and EHS Insight, which was eliminated immediately due to its $70,000 price. Novara won primarily because they were the cheapest, at $4,400 annually, plus $15,000 for implementation, with Intelex at $15,000/year, implementation included. Novara also offered the only product that did not require logins for all 400 Florim USA employees. Had they not chosen Novara, Julie probably would have researched alternative vendors that met this requirement. Novara stood out for bringing additional resources to the sales discussions, people who were knowledgeable about building an ISO framework, a key objective for Florim USA. Post-sale, Florim USA discovered the training module wasn't included as promised in the sales discussions, and Novara wanted $3,600 to add it. For three weeks, Julie went back and forth with the company until they finally agreed they'd made a mistake and added the training module for no extra charge. This experience was "a giant red flag," leaving Florim USA questioning their choice of vendor.

> *"We ended up going with KPA ... They were the cheapest. That's why upper management liked them. But I also liked them. And in the office, we all thought it would be a great fit."*

OPPORTUNITY DETAILS

Decision:	Win	**Interviewee:**	Julie Knotts	**Buyer Type:**	Champion
Close Date:	19/12/2025	**Role:**	EHS Project Manager	**Industry:**	Manufacturing
Deal Amount:	$19,400	**Segment:**	SMB	**NAICS code:**	327120

COMPANY PROFILE

Florim USA is the second largest manufacturer of tile in the U.S., with 1.5 million square feet of manufacturing and warehouse space. Julie Knotts is the company's EHS Project Manager.

VISION FOR CHANGE

Readiness: Florim USA building safety culture; "people really starting to buy in"; new system important to furthering initiative

Florim USA was building a safety culture and "people [were] really starting to buy in." Since EHS was complex and required detailed documentation, upgrading their system was important to furthering this effort.

> *"Right now we're building our safety culture at this facility. People are really starting to buy in and we just we have to keep up with that. And there's so many parts of safety. There's so many different documents you have to have. Just our old systems weren't enough."*

Pain: Florim USA's EHS system "dated," manual; used paper folders to track employee training, certifications; inefficient, inadequate for OSHA, ISO audits

Florim USA was managing EHS manually, using paper folders to track data like employee training and certifications. Julie wasn't able to easily surface information. This was inefficient and would be problematic if OSHA wanted to inspect their records. The system also wasn't suited to supporting the ISO safety certification Florim USA wanted to achieve by the end of the year.

> *"Let's say OSHA ever shows up. Our old system was really just paper folders for everybody. It was dated and we needed something where I can just pull up any employee and see all their certifications that they have and when their trainings are due, things like that."*

Vision: Sought system to support ISO certification; manage, track, and document employee trainings, certifications, EHS metrics

Florim USA needed a system that could support ISO safety certification, which they hoped to have completed by the end of the year. Certifications were important to their customers, making them comfortable buying from Florim USA. For both ISO and internal purposes, the company needed an automated solution to efficiently manage, track, and document job hazard assessments, employee trainings and certifications, and other key data to make sure people had appropriate, up-to-date

training, and to create documentation for outside agencies such as OSHA if necessary. The system would drive efficiency, improve overall health and safety, and reduce accidents. Key metrics included injuries, near misses, and various other leading and lagging indicators.

> *"We ... needed an overall ISO system that was going to get us through our safety certification really, because the company wants to have that done by the end of this year. So job hazard assessments, training records was huge. Just document control."*
>
> *"We needed a software for ISO certifications for safety and environmental, but also we really needed to be able to manage our trainings and have documentation. Let's say OSHA ever shows up ... We needed something where I can just pull up any employee and see all their certifications that they have and when their trainings are due, things like that."*
>
> *"They come up with these certifications and then they put 'em out to market and our clients or different buyers catch on to 'em and they're like, 'Oh, well, now you've got to go get that. You got to have that so we feel comfortable buying your tile" ... That's a big driver."*

Business Case: New system would enable Florim USA to collect, analyze key metrics for EHS, workers' comp

Florim USA saw value in a new system that would enable them to collect and analyze key metrics including injuries, near misses, and various other leading and lagging indicators. This data would help them manage their EHS program more efficiently.

> *"I also do workers' comp. It all kind of feeds into that system as well. Our injuries, our near misses ... are also what we're looking at."*
>
> *"We can have leading indicators versus lagging."*

DECISION PROCESS

Julie worked with her boss, the EHS department manager, and Charlie, her counterpart. They were required to get quotes from three different vendors. After Julie started researching vendors on LinkedIn and other sites, Novara and other companies reached out to her, which she attributed to AI. The team looked at Novara, Intelex, and EHS Insight. They didn't have a set budget for the project because they were unfamiliar with the space, but EHS Insight was eliminated immediately because its $70,000 price was too high. As a result, the evaluation focused on Novara and Intelex. The team talked to sales reps, did demos, and spoke to references. To make the purchase, they had to sell their decision to upper management. Julie wasn't involved in the contract negotiations.

SALES|MARKETING|PRICING

Novara "cheapest" at $4.4K/year, plus $15K implementation; attractive to upper management; deciding factor in winning deal

Novara's price was the lowest of the three vendors, at $4,400 annually, plus a $15,000 fee for a customized implementation. Upper management favored them because they were "the cheapest." This was the deciding factor in Novara winning the deal.

> *"[Novara was] the cheapest. That's why upper management liked them."*
>
> *"Cash, money [was the deciding factor] ... Yeah, really it was cash."*
>
> *"KPA was $4,400 a year plus a $15,000 implementation fee. That's only a one-time fee ... to build the site to whatever we want."*

Sales Differentiator: Novara sales rep brought additional resources into sales conversation; Florim USA impressed by ISO focus

Julie liked how Cliff, her Novara sales rep, brought in two colleagues, Haleyanne and Jennifer, who would be building the website for Florim USA. They were able to be "more hands-on and specific," creating a stronger relationship between the vendor and Florim USA. Haleyanne spoke "ISO language," discussing how the website would be built specifically to an ISO framework. This was important to Florim USA, as one of their key requirements for the system was to help them achieve ISO safety certification.

> *"We had our salesperson, Cliff, and then he brought in the backend. So Haleyanne and Jennifer, who were actually building the website, he brought them in so they could be more hands-on and specific with us."*
>
> *"Once we got on with Haleyanne who was building the site, she was very specifically talking in ISO language with us and the framework, and how she was going to build this specifically to an ISO framework. And that was intriguing to us."*
>
> *"You have a feeling when you're talking to people ... Wth KPA and Novara, I got a little bit up the ladder from just the salesperson. I was able to talk to the people who were building the website."*

"Great" demos; rep took time to show Florim USA "everything [Novara] could do"

Florim USA had "quite a few demos" of Novara. The demos were "great," with Cliff, the sales rep, showing the evaluation team everything the product could do.

> *"We did quite a few demos."*

"The demo was great. Cliff took a lot of time on the demo and he was able to show us everything the website was able to do."

EHS Insight's and Intelex's sales conversations were with reps only, no other resources

With both Intelex and EHS Insight, Florim USA spoke to sale reps only. No other resources were brought into these conversations.

"[With Intelex and EHS Insight] I hadn't been able to talk to anyone besides the salesperson."

Intelex $15K/year for "smaller package of items"; implementation included

Intelex was priced at $15,000/year for "a smaller package of items" than what Novara offered, with no implementation fee.

"Intelex, came with a smaller package of items and it was $15,000 a year."

EHS Insight eliminated immediately for high pricing; "way out of the ballpark" at $70K/year

Although Florim USA didn't have a set budget for this project, they eliminated EHS Insight immediately because their price, at $70,000 annually for the licenses, was "way out of the ballpark."

"[EHS Insight] was way out of the ballpark. It was gonna end up being $70,000 a year for the program and the company just wasn't gonna swing that."

Post Decision: "Stalemate" created when Novara quoted additional $3.6K for training module that was promised in sales discussions; delayed onboarding

When Florim USA realized the training module was missing from their system, they went back to Cliff, their Novara sales rep, reminding him that this had been promised as part of the deal. They had emails documenting this, but Cliff came back with a quote for $3,600/year extra for the training module, increasing the total annual cost by about 80%. The training module was essential to the ISO certification Florim USA was seeking. Julie had ranked this third of her top five priorities during sales discussions. Without the training module, the system "wasn't worth it," and Julie thought they were going to have to "call it quits." Her CFO had been in some of the early sales discussions and believed the training module was included, so he was not going to approve the extra amount. The dispute was "a giant red flag" for Florim USA, and made them question whether they should go ahead with Novara. They went back and forth for about three weeks, and "things got a little rocky," but finally Novara apologized for the error. New paperwork was signed, including the training module for $0.00 per year. During this stalemate, training on the new system was halted for three weeks, which was frustrating to Julie and her colleagues. On the day of this interview, Julie still couldn't see the training module when she logged on, but was hopeful it would be available in a day or two.

"We were in one of our sessions with Haleyanne and Jennifer, and we noticed we did not have the training module, which we were supposed to have. It was agreed on when we were talking through

everything that would be included that we would have the training module."

"Reached out to [our Novara sales rep] and we had a pretty long discussion in a Zoom call where we told him, 'You know, we have emails where this was included. Now you're saying it's not.' He sent us a quote for ... around $3,600 per year extra ... We agreed to $4,400 per year and now for the training you're adding on [$3,600]. That's 80% increase."

"We were at a stalemate, so I thought we were done. I thought we were going to have to call it quits ... Because for ISO, you also have to have training management. It's a huge part of the program. Without that, it just wasn't worth it to us at that point."

"Things got a little rocky for a minute, and then Cliff's boss got involved. And they ended up saying, 'This was our mistake. It was a misunderstanding.' ... And they would give us the training under our agreement."

"The bad thing about it is that whole situation ... took about three weeks ... During that time, we missed weeks of training, learning how to use the site with Haleyanne and Jennifer."

"Last week we signed paperwork for the training module, added on $0.00 for the year ... They said we should have the training module now, but I logged in this morning, ... We still don't have access to it ... Hopefully today or tomorrow we will."

"We wasted almost a month trying to come to this resolution. And they ended up giving it to us, because we were gonna have to walk. But I feel like it didn't have to get to that point."

"When you start a relationship with red flags ... It makes it a little confusing ... It makes it a little like, 'Even if they give us what we want, do we still want to go with them?'... 'Do we still want to do this?' ... It feels like a giant red flag."

"We would have had to walk because the company [was] not going to approve it ... Our CFO was in some of those initial meetings with our salesperson on what would be included ... We would have walked, a hundred percent."

PRODUCT

Product Differentiator: Novara only tool that allowed exclusive access to EHS team to manually input data; no company-wide logins required

Julie and her two EHS colleagues wanted a system that only they could access, inputting whatever data they wanted manually. Other systems required setting up logins for all 400 employees, who would then complete quizzes to input their own information.

"I believe [Novara] is the only one ... where only the three of us could have access to it and we could really manually enter in what we needed. We could manually enter in group training sessions, we could manually enter in dates and whatnot. It didn't have to be every single employee had to log in, do a quiz, and then submit that quiz."

Product Gap: Disliked Intelex, EHS Insight's requirement that all 400 employees have logins, ability to input information directly

Florim USA didn't want to create logins for all 400 employees or allow them to input their own information, but both Intelex and EHS Insight required this. Had they not chosen Novara, Julie said she probably would have done more research to identify other vendors that did not have this requirement.

> *"[Intelex and EHS Insight] are built around every single employee having a login. All 400 of our people have to have a login to utilize the website and that's the only way it works. We didn't want that."*

> *"[If Novara hadn't been chosen] it would have been starting from ground zero again and trying to find someone who we could use within our office, and not every employee would have to have a login."*

Novara included everything Florim USA needed, "a great fit"

> *"We were able to get everything we needed from KPA."*

> *"We all thought it would be a great fit."*

Novara's training module was essential for Florim USA to achieve ISO safety certification; "huge part of the program"

Florim USA needed training management to achieve ISO safety certification and Novara offered this. Although not mandatory, ISO certifications were important to Florim USA's customers.

> *"For ISO, you ... have to have training management. It's a huge part of the program."*

SERVICES|CX|CUSTOMER SUCCESS

Post Decision: Working with Novara "every week" to build software; "pretty big" meetings every Wednesday

> *"Where we're at right now, we're working with [Haleyanne and Jennifer] every week to build the software."*

> *"We are set to have meetings every Wednesday, that's put in our calendar. Last week we had a pretty big one to map out some ISO framework. And then I believe this Wednesday will be another pretty big training session."*

ACTIONS AND OPPORTUNITIES

Topic	Description
Action: Ensure issues accessing training module are resolved	On the day of the interview, Julie was still unable to access the training module when she logged onto Novara's system. She was hopeful this would be resolved in a day or two, but a follow-up would be appropriate to ensure this is now accessible.

Recording: https://app.box.com/s/j4t0f8jg0433kr6flnm6beo2o3m6ro2s

TRANSCRIPT

Julie
Totally fine with me.

IcebergIQ
Okay, great. So once again, Julie, thank you so much for taking the time to speak with me today. And in a moment, we're going to have a conversation about your recent experience with Novara or KPA, as I know some people refer to them as. Before we do that though, I would love to ... I was on your website and I'd love to hear a little bit more about Florim USA, your organization.

Julie
Yeah, we are, I believe, the second largest producer of porcelain tile in the U.S. We are a million and a half square feet, so we are manufacturing in warehouse, create porcelain tile. Dirt comes in, beautiful tile comes out. This program, we're utilizing it within our EHS department. So I am in Environmental Health and Safety and we needed a software for ISO certifications for safety and environmental, but also we really needed to be able to manage our trainings and have documentation. Let's say OSHA ever shows up. Our old system was really just paper folders for everybody. It was dated and we needed something where I can just pull up any employee and see all their certifications that they have and when their trainings are due, things like that.

IcebergIQ
Okay, you got a little bit ahead of me there.

Julie
Sorry.

IcebergIQ
No, That's great. Yeah, so the organization, great number of employees that you have there?

Julie
It's around 400.

IcebergIQ
400. Okay, great. Yeah, and your title or role there?

Julie
I am EHS Project Manager.

IcebergIQ
Project Manager. Okay, great. Alright, so turning to the subject at hand, Novara, I was hearing you talk about ... My first question is usually what was leading to the need to have discussions with them and others. And I think I heard some of that. You're talking about maintaining ISO certification, about getting away from manual processes.

Julie
Mm-hmm. I had so many calls in the beginning because our company, they wanted us to go out to market and get three different quotes from three different software companies. I feel like I've had this talk so many times. I have it down to a science of, the points I need to hit on. So that's why I just went right into it.

IcebergIQ
No, no, but I just want to summarize that before I move on. Was there anything else that you were, that you were trying to accomplish or outcomes you were looking for as you went to market to find a solution here?

Julie
We just needed an overall ISO system that was going to get us through our safety certification really, because the company wants to have that done by the end of this year. So job hazard assessments, training records was huge. Just document control.

IcebergIQ
Okay, it's just about the accuracy, the control of it. What's the business case or the ... behind making that investment.

Julie
Mm-hmm. Well, repeat that question so I can make sure I answer it.

IcebergIQ
Well, I'm wondering, what the driver is behind improving ... You're going to more manual, going from manual to more automatic, getting that certification. Is it around improving efficiency internally? Is it about improving the overall health and safety of the ... Or reducing accidents-?

Julie
All the above.

IcebergIQ
Okay.

Julie
Yeah, all the above. We can have, leading indicators versus lagging. And I think right now we're building our safety culture at this facility. People are really starting to buy in and we just we have to keep up with that. And

there's so many parts of safety. There's so many different documents you have to have. Just our old systems weren't enough.

IcebergIQ
Okay. And are there any specific metrics that you're tracking or those that are really important as it relates to this area?

Julie
Of course, injuries. I also do workers comp. It all kind of feeds into that system as well. Our injuries, our near misses-

IcebergIQ
Okay.

Julie
... are also what we're looking at.

IcebergIQ
Okay. And I notice on your website, that you're the largest ... It says you're the largest manufacturer to achieve a WELL health-safety rating. Well, now why is that important? What's that-

Julie
That was during COVID. So that was a big thing during COVID. I don't know if you remember, it was commercials on TV. Lady Gaga would get on there, and I believe Leonardo DiCaprio, and they were talking about these businesses who were going the extra mile during COVID to keep their workers safe. And that was a part of that.

IcebergIQ
Okay. I gotcha. So that was a, at the time, a certain designation you could-

Julie
Yeah.

IcebergIQ
Okay, terrific.

Julie
I don't know if it matters, to be honest, I don't know if it matters anymore, but I think it was ... These certifications, they're kind of just money makers. You know what I mean? They come up with these certifications and then they put 'em out to market and our clients or different buyers catch on to 'em and they're like, "Oh, well, now you've got to go get that. You got to have that so we feel comfortable buying your tile." Sustainability and being carbon neutral is kind of the same. So-

IcebergIQ
Yeah, gotsa.

Julie
That's a big driver.

IcebergIQ
Okay, I got you. Alright, you're going to market now to resolve these problems. Tell me about how you organized yourself, who all was involved, and how you decided who you wanted to talk to.

Julie
Well, funny enough, a lot of the companies reached out to me. So I believe I found one company. I would have to look up the name again, because it was way out of the ballpark. It was gonna end up being $70,000 a year for the program and the company just wasn't gonna swing that. And then we found there was Intelex and then there was KPA. And I believe KPA found me. I don't believe-

IcebergIQ
Okay.

Julie
I believe they reached out to me first and probably through AI and other, other ways of finding me. Because I was going out to LinkedIn and things like that to find others, so that might be how they found me. But it was really up to me, but it was also my team, my boss, who was the manager of our department, and then my counterpart, Charlie. The three of us really had a good idea of what we needed, and then we just had to sell it to upper management afterwards.

IcebergIQ
And as you went to market, did you have a list of criteria or a budget that you ... What did that all look like? What was on your shopping list?

Julie
We really ... I'm going to be honest, we didn't really have a budget because we didn't know what we were looking at. We knew we didn't want to spend, but we kind of came up with, "Here's what's out there and here's what they provide and here's the yearly cost." And I believe KPA and Intelex were kind of similar, but we ended up going with KPA. I think they were probably the cheapest, if I'm being honest. I think they were the cheapest. That's why upper management liked them. But I also liked them. And in the office, we all thought it would be a great fit.

IcebergIQ
Okay. I guess you originally looked at three vendors. The one that you can't recall, maybe you dismissed right off because they were too expensive.

Julie
Mm-hmm.

IcebergIQ
And then you really did a side by side with the two remaining vendors. Is that how it worked?

Julie
Yeah, let me see. I know it's in my notebook, but let me see if I can maybe find the name of that first one. Might just take me a second to go back through my emails, but you're good to keep asking follow-ups.

IcebergIQ
Okay. In terms of how you did your analysis, how you evaluated the two programs, what did that look like? Did you ... Obviously you talked to the sales teams. Did you do demos? Did you look at references? How did all that work?

Julie
All the above. Once we zoned in on KPA, we did quite a few demos. We had our salesperson, Cliff, and then he brought in the backend. So Haleyanne and Jennifer, who were actually building the website, he brought them in so they could be more hands-on and specific with us. And now, where we're at right now, we're working with them every week to build the software.

IcebergIQ
Okay, so this is a fairly new adoption?

Julie
Yes.

IcebergIQ
Okay. Alright. Getting back to the discussions with the sales teams. Were there any tools demonstrated, was there anything that was particularly useful to you in terms of helping you with your assessment?

Julie
The demo was great. Cliff took a lot of time on the demo and he was able to show us everything the website was able to do.

IcebergIQ
Okay. And just in general how you would characterize the sales interaction and conversations you were having with their team?

Julie
It was good. It was good in the beginning. Now, I don't know if we want to go all the way through that yet or ... Because there were some issues down the road.

IcebergIQ
Okay. I do want to talk about kind of post-decision, post-sale, the implementation. I take it that's where that's going to come up.

Julie
Yeah.

IcebergIQ
Okay, yeah, let me finish just with your analysis and the decision. So you have the two side by side. Obviously you went with KPA, but what were the deciding factors there?

Julie
Cash, money. We were ... Yeah, really it was cash. And then we were able to get everything we needed from KPA. And once we got on with Haleyanne who was building the site, she was very specifically talking in ISO

language with us and the framework, and how she was going to build this specifically to an ISO framework. And that was intriguing to us.

IcebergIQ
And Haley, that was the sales rep or the-?

Julie
Haleyanne is her name and she is ... She's not sales, she's building the websites. I believe she's probably an engineer.

IcebergIQ
Okay, terrific. You mentioned cost was, seemed to be a big driving factor. How big of a gap was it between them and their competitor?

Julie
Intelex ... Well, the first one ended up being right around $70,000 a year for the licenses. That was just way out of the ballpark. The second one, Intelex, came with a smaller package of items and it was $15,000 a year. And then KPA was $4,400 a year plus a $15,000 implementation fee. That's only a one-time fee. So they were really on par with Intelex but it's a one-time fee, to build the site to whatever we want. They gave us a certain number of man hours basically to get it done with Haleyanne and Jennifer. And we're still working through that now.

IcebergIQ
Okay. And in terms of the products themselves, how were they different? Did you see anything that was materially different in the two platforms? Was there anything that stood out?

Julie
It seemed like some of these programs were a little different here. A lot of these softwares are built around every single employee having a login. All 400 of our people have to have a login to utilize the website and that's the only way it works. We didn't want that, because we're just not there yet. So we like this one and I believe this one is the only one that worked this way, where only the three of us could have access to it and we could really manually enter in what we needed. We could manually enter in group training sessions, we could manually enter in dates and whatnot. It didn't have to be every single employee had to log in, do a quiz, and then submit that quiz, if that makes sense.

IcebergIQ
Okay, so that was a feature of the Novara KPA-

Julie
Mm-hmm.

IcebergIQ
... but not Intelex. That you had to have individual logins for-

Julie
Yes.

IcebergIQ

... some of their platform. Okay.

Julie
Yes. And the same as the first. I can go look at my notebook here in a minute to see who that was.

IcebergIQ
Okay. While you're doing that, was there anything else in terms of, I don't know, reporting or dashboards, user experience? Any of that that you felt was particularly good, weak, strong, in either of the platforms?

Julie
Not really. We are still diving in. I don't want to get into all the negatives just yet, but it's been a slow start.

IcebergIQ
Okay.

Julie
Yeah, it's been a slow start.

IcebergIQ
Okay. Teah, I want to get into that. I want to get into the post-sale discussion. Before I move on to that, anything else about the product or platform in terms of your assessment that is worth adding to the discussion?

Julie
I don't think so.

IcebergIQ
Okay. So the decision came. It was primarily based on pricing. It sounds like this login piece was important too.

Julie
Mm-hmm.

IcebergIQ
Let me ask you this. If the competitor had those two functions, how would you have made your decision? If they were similar in price, if they were ... didn't have the individual login issue.

Julie
It might have come down to a feeling. You know what I'm saying? You have a feeling when you're talking to people. So, for instance, with KPA and Novara, I got a little bit up the ladder from just the salesperson. I was able to talk to the people who were building the website. On the others, I hadn't been able to talk to anyone besides the salesperson. So maybe it comes down to a feeling. Or ...

IcebergIQ
A relationship?

Julie
Yeah.

IcebergIQ
Yeah, okay. No, that's a good addition, thank you. Alright, so the decision comes, you let them know. Tell me about what's going on post-decision, tell me about the whole onboarding experience.

Julie
We got into the website, contract signed, that went back and forth a little bit. Over my head. I wasn't really involved so much in a lot of that. But the contract finally got signed, capped increase per year, whatever. After that, we were in one of our sessions with Haleyanne and Jennifer, and we noticed we did not have the training module, which we were supposed to have. It was agreed on when we were talking through everything that would be included that we would have the training module. So they were like, "Okay, reach out to Cliff and see about that, see what he can do." Reached out to him and we had a pretty long discussion in a Zoom call where we told him, "You know, we have emails where this was included. Now you're saying it's not." He sent us a quote for, I believe, it was around $3,600 per year extra. So when you're looking at it in terms of, we agreed to $4,400 per year and now for the training you're adding on $36,000. That's 80% increase.

IcebergIQ
$3,600, right?

Julie
$3,600. I'm sorry, $3,600 increase. We had to go back and forth a lot and I was trying to send him documentation from our earlier conversation showing the training documentation was really what we needed, training management. He had promised that in the beginning, didn't have it, wanted us to pay for it. We were at a stalemate, so I thought we were done. I thought we were going to have to call it quits ... Because for ISO, you also have to have training management. It's a huge part of the program. Without that, it just wasn't worth it to us at that point.

And things got a little rocky for a minute, and then Cliff's boss got involved. And they ended up saying, "This was our mistake. It was a misunderstanding." Scott had called me on the phone and he said it was all a big misunderstanding. And they would give us the training under our agreement. They should have done it. He said there was a line item that wasn't entered in, and on the backend, they would improve their training. So I'm not sure, but that was-

IcebergIQ
They would improve their training in terms of how they build quotes? Not-?

Julie
Either build quotes or how they enter things into their system.

IcebergIQ
I see.

Julie
How they're entering in what customers get within their system.

IcebergIQ
So it was an error on their part that they kind of admitted to and now they're trying to deal with it.

Julie
Yes.

IcebergIQ
Okay, so, yeah. Carry on.

Julie
Yeah. But the bad thing about it is that whole situation, which was pretty straightforward and easy, it took about three weeks. Because we weren't getting emails back from Cliff or they were taking a pretty long time, because I'm sure he had to get approval way up the line on what to say, what to do. But during that time, we missed weeks of training, learning how to use the site with Haleyanne and Jennifer.

I could tell it was a little aggravating for them as well because they didn't know what was going on, on the sales side. They didn't know that we were at a stalemate, and so they were trying to go on with training when we didn't even know if we were going to have the site to use. I'm glad it got worked out. So it came to a resolution last week. Last week we signed, paperwork for the training module, added on $0.00 for the year as it should have been included. And I believe we signed that on Wednesday morning and sent that in. And they said we should have the training module now, but I logged in this morning, because I wanted to give them some time and it's still not open for us. We still don't have access to it. I did email them to let them know we still didn't have access. Hopefully today or tomorrow we will.

IcebergIQ
Okay. And so the resolution was they're not charging. Is there going to be a charge in subsequent years?

Julie
That's what we asked. Then our purchase manager was involved the entire time and he was asking Cliff in years two and three, was there going to be increases for the training? And quite honestly, he was getting very roundabout answers. Typical salesperson answers that weren't exactly clear. So I had to step back in, ask a very pointed question and Cliff said, "No, you will not be charged in the coming years. This should have been included."

IcebergIQ
Wow. You ended up getting a ... It's been a bit of a problem, but you ended up getting a, I think, a pretty decent deal out of it at their expense.

Julie
Exactly. In the beginning ... And I had sent Cliff this email back from our first conversations where he said, "These are your top five items." Training management, I believe, was the third highest, second or third highest item, and it was documented and then it wasn't included in the software.

IcebergIQ
Yeah, obviously a mistake on their side and, well, certainly hopefully that gets all ironed out, you get access in the next ... pretty quickly and you're able to carry on with your implementation. Apart from that, has the ... Is there a roadmap in terms of the implementation or in terms of ongoing cadence of meetings with the customer success team and so forth that you've been able to establish?

Julie

Yeah. We are set to have meetings every Wednesday, that's put in our calendar. Last week we had a pretty big one to map out some ISO framework. And then I believe this Wednesday will be another pretty big training session.

IcebergIQ
Okay. Overall, what advice would you have for them, based on the whole experience, what would you want them to hear?

Julie
Hmm. I understand issues happen, but we wasted a whole week, we wasted almost a month trying to come to this resolution. And they ended up giving it to us, because we were gonna have to walk. But I feel like it didn't have to get to that point. We gave plenty of documentation and proof of, "This is what you said. This is what you had promised." And it just didn't feel like we were getting anywhere until – Scott is his name – until Scott stepped in. And he said he had looked back through the system and researched what happened, and it was a line item that was missed. Well, maybe, but I just feel like it didn't have to get to where it did. Because, sure, that situation was with the salesperson, and we might never have to deal with the salesperson again. Maybe we do, but when you start a relationship with red flags, it just makes … It makes it a little confusing, you know? It makes it a little like, "Ah. Even if they give us what we want, do we still want to go with them?"

IcebergIQ
Hmm.

Julie
"Do we still want to do this?" Because that was a real worry for us. "Even if they do give us training, do we still want to do this?" Because it feels like a giant red flag.

IcebergIQ
Okay. So had they not done that, you guys would have walked and what would you have done? Would you have gone back to a different vendor?

Julie
Yeah. Yeah, we would have had to walk because the company, they were not going to approve it based on conversations we had already had in the past. And our CFO was in some of those initial meetings with our salesperson on what would be included, and he had had some questions. And there were quite a few meetings before anything was certain. So I felt like it was very clear what we were needing.

IcebergIQ
Okay.

Julie
And yeah, we would have walked, a hundred percent.

IcebergIQ
And would you have gone to Intelex, gone back to them, or something else?

Julie

Possibly, possibly. Chances are it would have been starting from ground zero again and trying to find someone who we could use within our office, and not every employee would have to have a login. It's hard to find.

IcebergIQ
Okay, is there anything else that I'm missing from the whole story or experience?

Julie
I don't think so. I think we're in an alright place now. We're good with the designers of the software, the two ladies who are working on it, we work great with them. It was just the scope of work on what was promised and then what was delivered. The amount of time in between replies, it just felt like it just went on and on and on.

IcebergIQ
Yeah. Okay.

Julie
And I'm not meaning for this to be negative because we still went with them. So obviously, they have redeeming qualities and it's a great software and we want to use it. But the training management was such a huge portion and we emphasized that over and over again. If we wouldn't have had that, then we would have had to back out.

IcebergIQ
Yeah, that's a big miss on their side for sure. Okay. Julie, it's been great meeting you. I've enjoyed the discussion. Were you able to find the name of that other competitor?

Julie
Give me two seconds. We're about to log off. Let me go grab my notebook and I'll be right back.

IcebergIQ
Oh, okay, great. Thanks. You can also ...

Julie
Okay. It was EHS Insights.

IcebergIQ
Okay, great. Thanks so much for doing that.

Julie
You're welcome.

IcebergIQ
Yep. Enjoy the rest of your day. Have a great week and thank you so much.

Julie
You too. Thank you.

IcebergIQ
Okay. Bye.

Julie
Bye.